INDIA TODAY RPG Happiness Quest

VOX POP

SACHIN PILOT, 45

Former deputy chief minister, Rajasthan



BANDEEP SINGH

"I am one of those who believe that happiness comes more from within than from outside. We have to think of each day, each moment as an opportunity for us to seek out joy and happiness. I also believe that it's the smaller things in life that give us contentment and satisfaction. I am happiest spending time with my two sons, Aaran, 15, and Vehaan, 13. It could be going to the mall or to the theatre to watch a film together and binging on popcorn and junk food. Recently, we went go-karting. These moments are precious. Because of the nature of my job, I don't get to spend as much time with my family as I would have liked to. Ultimately, it's your family and friends who matter and help you through the highs and lows of life."

BANDEEP SINGH



SANJEEV SANYAL, 52

Author and Member of the Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council

"We all seek happiness, but there is no universal way to define it. There are things that bring happiness in the moment. The moment itself may be ephemeral, but the happiness may be deeply meaningful—the joy of a Sunday lunch with family, of walking alone in the mountains, of reading a good book, of meeting an old friend. There is also the happiness of completing a difficult project, or of achieving some goal, or of watching one's children grow up. Then there is the more abstract satisfaction of standing up for a cherished idea."

VIVEK R NAIR



HIMA DAS, 22

Athlete

"For me, happiness means running. Not just for a medal or glory, but to express myself. I run to test myself, to challenge myself, to explore the limits of human excellence. For me, happiness is also being in the lap of nature. As someone from the northeast, it's in my DNA. Even when I travel to other cities and countries, I love exploring the greens nearby. But nothing makes me happier than being surrounded by family and friends. And in such a state of mind, I love to cook, occasionally."

NIKHAT ZAREEN, 26

Boxer



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"Doing what I love and achieving success after a lot of struggle and hard work makes me happy. Becoming the World Champion was the happiest and most emotional moment of my life. All my sacrifices felt worth it. It changed my life. I was really proud of myself... and it fulfilled my dream of meeting my favourite actor, Salman Khan."

Contributed by *Kaushik Deka, M.G. Arun, Amarnath K. Menon, Suhani Singh, Jumana Shah, Anilesh S. Mahajan, Rohit Parihar, Romita Datta, Ajay Sukumaran, Amitabh Srivastava, Prashant Srivastava, Shelly Anand, Dhaval Kulkarni, Pushyamitra, Himanshu Shekhar, Pradeepika Saraswat, Chumki Bharadwaj and Ridhi Kale*